

# Stephen Christopher Cooke

Stephencooke.c@gmail.com | 647-963-3783 | Pickering, ON, L1V 2LS
***linkedin.com/in/stephen-cooke-b853702ab***

## Key skills

- **Systems Administration**: Proficient in managing Linux distributions (Arch Linux, Fedora, Debian, and Linux Mint) and Windows Server environments.
- **Cybersecurity**: Experienced in implementing BitLocker and LUKS encryption, GRUB rescue techniques, and securing systems with SSL/TLS certificates and best practices like MFA and SSO.
- **Disaster Recovery & Backup**: Skilled in using open-source tools like Clonezilla for system restoration and maintaining resilience through robust disaster recovery planning.
- **Networking & VLAN Configuration**: Skilled in TCP/IP, DNS, routing, firewall configuration, and VLAN segmentation using OpenWrt for optimized and secure networks.

## Objective

Resourceful IT professional with extensive experience in Linux system administration, networking, and cybersecurity. Proficient in deploying secure, robust systems and fostering strong client relationships. Skilled in applying key cybersecurity principles, including network segmentation, compartmentalization, obfuscation, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO), to enhance system security and resilience. Known for being a reliable single point of contact and ensuring users feel supported through proactive communication. Committed to leveraging technology to serve users and drive innovative solutions in dynamic environments. Actively engaged in ongoing professional development.

## Experience

- Practical IT Experience
- Nextcloud Self-Hosting via Docker
- Deployed and managed Nextcloud instances on a self-hosted server using Docker, hosting cookeincode.com to provide a centralized platform for showcasing and selling unique products while enabling on-demand 3D Printing as a Service.
- Operate this venture, CookeInCode Pty Ltd, as a secondary endeavour, combining a personal hobby with ongoing career development in I.T., with plans to engage in prototyping new ideas in the I.T. space and for other companies.
- OpenVPN Server & Certificate Management
- Configured OpenVPN servers and managed SSL/TLS certificates to establish secure connections for remote access and site-to-site communications.
- Customized and compiled OpenWRT firmware for routers to optimize performance, enhance security, and implement advanced features such as VLAN traffic segmentation.
- Automation with Monit & Docker-Compose
- Designed self-healing Docker-Compose environments using Monit and health checks to maintain system uptime.
- Implemented disaster recovery plans and executed system restoration tasks using open-source tools such as Clonezilla, ensuring business continuity.

- **Automation & Monitoring**: Experienced in Docker-Compose, Monit, and Portainer for self-healing systems and containerized deployments.
- **Client & Stakeholder Communication**: Strong interpersonal skills with the ability to explain technical concepts to non-technical users and maintain excellent client relationships.
- **Technical Problem-Solving**: Adept at troubleshooting multi-OS environments and deploying efficient, user-focused IT solutions.

## Education

**RMIT (via Open Universities Australia)**
***Bachelor of Information Technology (Incomplete)***

- COSC2678 Building IT Systems: High Distinction
- COSC2452 Introduction to Programming: Distinction
- COSC2196 Introduction to Information Technology: Distinction

## Interests

- **Linux and Open-Source Technologies**: Passionate about exploring and mastering Linux distributions, open-source tools, and their practical applications in cybersecurity and systems administration.
- **Home Automation and IoT**: Engaged in creating innovative solutions using platforms like Raspberry Pi, integrating smart devices, and optimizing home networks for seamless connectivity.
- **Cybersecurity Awareness**: Actively following industry trends and enhancing my knowledge of encryption, intrusion detection, and emerging technologies to improve system security and resilience.
- **3D Printing and Prototyping**: Designing and manufacturing unique items using CAD tools like Blender and Fusion 360, combining technical skills with creativity to explore product development opportunities.
- **Continuous Learning**: Passionate about developing practical technical expertise through ongoing study, real-world problem solving, and hands-on experience across networking, systems administration, cybersecurity, and IT infrastructure.

## Career history

**Owner & Managing Director | CookeInCode Pty Ltd**
***October 2024 – Present***

- Operate a small, on-demand business offering IT solutions, consulting, and custom 3D-printed items.
- Host and manage cookeincode.com to showcase products, facilitate on-demand 3D Printing as a Service, and direct traffic to Etsy and eBay storefronts.
- Enhance technical expertise, entrepreneurial skills, and creative problem-solving through this venture.
- Focus on combining personal passion with ongoing career development in I.T., with plans to expand into prototyping services for commercial contracts.

**IT Intern | Diamond IT**
July 2024 – September 2024

- Gained hands-on experience with Windows Server, Microsoft Azure, and Microsoft 365, focusing on system administration and cloud integration.
- Configured and managed servers, set up cloud resources, and troubleshot system issues.
- Developed technical proficiency in deploying and maintaining IT solutions across diverse platforms.

**Account Executive | Aon**
March 2010 – June 2015

- Specialized in Account Receivable Insurance, providing innovative solutions for domestic and international trade risks.
- Consistently exceeded new business targets, earning positive performance reviews and performance bonuses.
- Managed Canadian exposures within international Aon programs and cultivated relationships with insurance markets.
- Recognized with the 2012 Summit North Award for Top Producer, showcasing exceptional contributions to the organization.

**Sales Agent | Coface Canada**
March 2006 – June 2010

- Managed and expanded a portfolio of clients while driving new business development.
- Conducted strategic marketing, orchestrated prospect meetings, and delivered impactful presentations.
- Executed targeted campaigns, resulting in substantial client growth and a high level of client satisfaction.
- Maintained exceptional client service, contributing to notable business growth.

**Customer Service Representative | Minacs**
June 2003 – June 2004

- Promoted to work on the Bell account after three months due to exceptional customer service performance.
- Assigned to the Government of Ontario account, showcasing recognized customer service excellence.

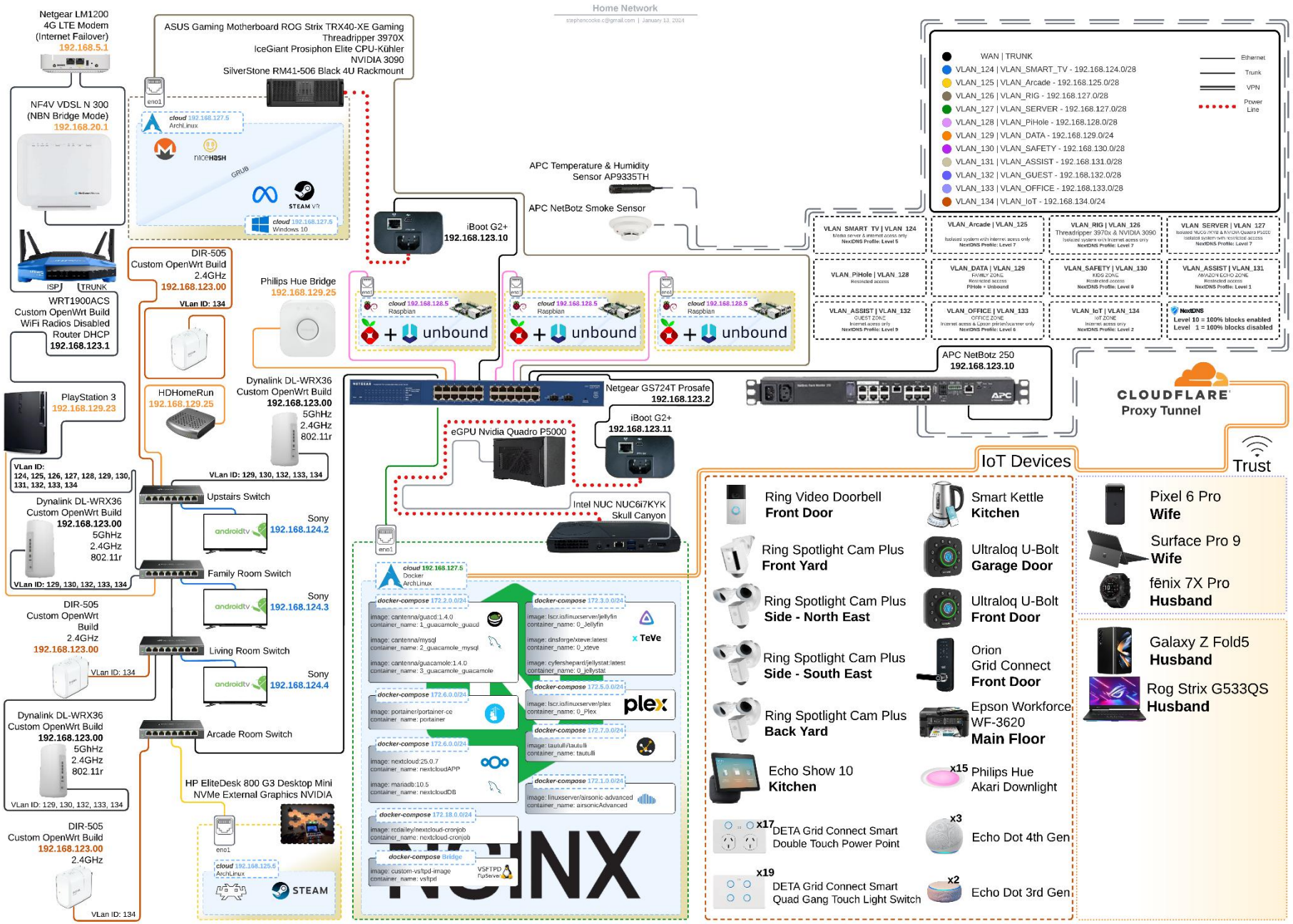
**Retail Supervisor | Compucentre**
*August 2002 – June 2003*

- Provided IT support, including computer repairs and upgrades, and conducted face-to-face sales to help customers find suitable products.
- Promoted to supervisor for outstanding sales performance and customer service, managing store operations and supervising staff.

**Assistant Supervisor | Georgeson Shareholder**
*July 2001 – August 2002*

- Handled shareholder communication, proxy solicitation, and customer service operations.

- Promoted to Assistant Supervisor for strong interpersonal skills, overseeing customer service and ensuring client satisfaction.


Home Network
Netgear LM1200
4G LTE Modem
(Internet Failover)
192.168.5.1
NF4V VDSL N 300
(NBN Bridge Mode)
192.168.20.1
ISP
TRUNK
WRT1900ACS
Custom OpenWrt Build
WiFi Radios Disabled
Router DHCP
192.168.123.1
ASUS Gaming Motherboard ROG Strix TRX40-XE Gaming
Threadripper 3970X
IceGiant Prosiphon Elite CPU-Kühler
NVIDIA 3090
SilverStone RM41-506 Black 4U Rackmount
eno1
cloud 192.168.127.5
ArchLinux
niceHASH
GRUB
STEAM VR
cloud 192.168.127.5
Windows 10
APC Temperature & Humidity
Sensor AP9335TH
APC NetBotz Smoke Sensor
iBoot G2+
192.168.123.10
DIR-505
Custom OpenWrt Build
2.4GHz
192.168.123.00
VLan ID: 134
Philips Hue Bridge
192.168.129.25
cloud 192.168.128.5
Raspbian
unbound
WAN | TRUNK
VLAN_124 | VLAN_SMART_TV - 192.168.124.0/28
VLAN_125 | VLAN_Arcade - 192.168.125.0/28
VLAN_126 | VLAN_RIG - 192.168.127.0/28
VLAN_127 | VLAN_SERVER - 192.168.127.0/28
VLAN_128 | VLAN_PiHole - 192.168.128.0/28
VLAN_129 | VLAN_DATA - 192.168.129.0/24
VLAN_130 | VLAN_SAFETY - 192.168.130.0/28
VLAN_131 | VLAN_ASSIST - 192.168.131.0/28
VLAN_132 | VLAN_GUEST - 192.168.132.0/28
VLAN_133 | VLAN_OFFICE - 192.168.133.0/28
VLAN_134 | VLAN_IoT - 192.168.134.0/24
Ethernet
Trunk
VPN
Power Line
VLAN_SMART_TV | VLAN_124
VLAN_Arcade | VLAN_125
VLAN_RIG | VLAN_126
Threadripper 3970x & NVIDIA 3090
VLAN_SERVER | VLAN_127
VLAN_PiHole | VLAN_128
VLAN_DATA | VLAN_129
FAMILY ZONE
VLAN_SAFETY | VLAN_130
KIDS ZONE
VLAN_ASSIST | VLAN_131
AMAZON ECHO ZONE
VLAN_ASSIST | VLAN_132
GUEST ZONE
VLAN_OFFICE | VLAN_133
OFFICE ZONE
VLAN_IoT | VLAN_134
IoT ZONE
NextDNS
Level 10 = 100% blocks enabled
Level 1 = 100% blocks disabled
APC NetBotz 250
192.168.123.10
CLOUDFLARE
Proxy Tunnel
PlayStation 3
192.168.129.23
HDHomeRun
192.168.129.25
Dynalink DL-WRX36
Custom OpenWrt Build
192.168.123.00
5GhHz
2.4GHz
802.11r
VLan ID: 129, 130, 132, 133, 134
VLan ID:
124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130,
131, 132, 133, 134
Netgear GS724T Prosafe
192.168.123.2
iBoot G2+
192.168.123.11
eGPU Nvidia Quadro P5000
Intel NUC NUC6i7KYK
Skull Canyon
Upstairs Switch
Sony
192.168.124.2
Family Room Switch
Sony
192.168.124.3
Living Room Switch
Sony
192.168.124.4
Arcade Room Switch
HP EliteDesk 800 G3 Desktop Mini
NVMe External Graphics NVIDIA
cloud 192.168.125.5
ArchLinux
STEAM
cloud 192.168.127.5
Docker
ArchLinux
docker-compose 172.2.0.0/24
image: cantenna/guacd:1.4.0
container_name: 1_guacamole_guacd
image: cantenna/mysql
container_name: 2_guacamole_mysql
image: cantenna/guacamole:1.4.0
container_name: 3_guacamole_guacamole
docker-compose 172.3.0.0/24
image: lscr.io/linuxserver/jellyfin
container_name: 0_Jellyfin
image: dnsforge/xteve:latest
container_name: 0_xteve
image: cybershepard/jellystat:latest
container_name: 0_jellystat
TeVe
docker-compose 172.6.0.0/24
image: portainer/portainer-ce
container_name: portainer
docker-compose 172.5.0.0/24
image: lscr.io/linuxserver/plex
container_name: 0_Plex
plex
docker-compose 172.7.0.0/24
image: tautulli/tautulli
container_name: tautulli
docker-compose 172.6.0.0/24
image: nextcloud:25.0.7
container_name: nextcloudAPP
image: mariadb:10.5
container_name: nextcloudDB
docker-compose 172.1.0.0/24
image: linuxserver/airsonic-advanced
container_name: airsonicAdvanced
docker-compose 172.18.0.0/24
image: rcdailey/nextcloud-cronjob
container_name: nextcloud-cronjob
docker-compose Bridge
image: custom-vsftpd-image
container_name: vsftpd
VSFTPD
FtpServer
NGINX
IoT Devices
Ring Video Doorbell
Front Door
Ring Spotlight Cam Plus
Front Yard
Ring Spotlight Cam Plus
Side - North East
Ring Spotlight Cam Plus
Side - South East
Ring Spotlight Cam Plus
Back Yard
Echo Show 10
Kitchen
x17
DETA Grid Connect Smart
Double Touch Power Point
x19
DETA Grid Connect Smart
Quad Gang Touch Light Switch
Smart Kettle
Kitchen
Ultraloq U-Bolt
Garage Door
Ultraloq U-Bolt
Front Door
Orion
Grid Connect
Front Door
Epson Workforce
WF-3620
Main Floor
x15
Philips Hue
Akari Downlight
x3
Echo Dot 4th Gen
x2
Echo Dot 3rd Gen
Trust
Pixel 6 Pro
Wife
Surface Pro 9
Wife
fēnix 7X Pro
Husband
Galaxy Z Fold5
Husband
Rog Strix G533QS
Husband